

Dr. Art E. Fact

Your grievance with Grant

Grant suppressed your research showing that two objects in his collection passed through a dealer linked to questionable wartime sales. He threatened to release correspondence suggesting you had overstated another provenance claim if you challenged him publicly.

Your other secret

One celebrated article of yours does contain an inference you stated too confidently. The main thesis still stands, but the mistake would be humiliating.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Ask Reed what he has discovered in the accession records.
3. Determine whether Claire commissioned outside provenance research.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Round 1 / Motive

When questioned, read your answer. It is the same whether you are innocent or the murderer.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

My research linked two collection objects to a dealer involved in questionable wartime sales. Grant suppressed it. He also threatened to release correspondence suggesting I had overstated a different claim. He wanted silence, and he had chosen a very effective threat.

Your next action

Ask the next seated guest their named Motive question in the question catalog. Note one grievance that might matter. Wait for the host before turning the page.

Round 2 / Opportunity

When questioned, read the answer for your role. Keep the section labels to yourself.

IF INNOCENT

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, showing him the disputed accession page. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the reference specimen stored inside.

IF MURDERER

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, showing him the disputed accession page. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the reference specimen stored inside.

After answering, ask the next seated guest their named Opportunity question in the catalog. Wait for the host before turning the page.

Round 3 / Method

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: IF INNOCENT = Card B; IF MURDERER = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

When questioned, read your answer below, then your selected receipt. Leave the unused card hidden.

IF INNOCENT

I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for dusting an archival display stand. That was what the materials desk issued me.

IF MURDERER

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for dusting an archival display stand. That was what the materials desk issued me.

Put the read receipt on the Evidence Table. Discuss, then vote privately. The host will distribute FINALE envelopes only after collecting all ballots.